Everlyn Asiko Chimoto

Research Scientist

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Google scholar: Google Scholar Profile

Personal website: https://everlynasiko.github.io/

Education

Ph.D. in Applied Mathematics
Jan 2022 - March 2026

University of Cape Town, African Institute for Mathematical Sciences, South Africa
Supervisor: Prof. Bruce Bassett
Dissertation: *Neural Machine Translation for Low-Resource Languages*

MSc in Mathematical Sciences
Nov 2020 - Aug 2021

University of Cape Town, African Institute for Mathematical Sciences, South Africa
Supervisor: Prof. Bruce Bassett
Thesis: Neural Machine Translation for Low-Resource Languages
Graduated *with Distinction*

BSc in Computer Science
Sept 2015 – Dec 2019

Masinde Muliro University of Science and Technology, Kenya
Supervisor: Mr. Michael Ujunju
Fourth Year Thesis: Accident Location Extraction Using Natural Language Processing
Graduated *with First Class Honours*

Publications

Everlyn Asiko Chimoto, Mostafa Elhoushi and Bruce A. Bassett. "Calibrating Beyond English: Language Diversity for Better Quantized Multilingual LLM." **In EACL 2026.** Rabat, Morocco.

Everlyn Asiko Chimoto, Constantine Lignos, Shamsuddeen Muhammad, Idris Abdulmumin, Clemencia Siro, and David Ifeoluwa Adelani. "Proceedings of the 7th Workshop on African Natural Language Processing (AfricaNLP 2026)" **In EACL 2026.** Rabat, Morocco.

Jenalea Rajab, Anuoluwapo Aremu, Everlyn Asiko Chimoto, Dale Dunbar, Graham Morrissey, Fadel Thior, Luandrie Potgieter, Jessica Ojo, Atnafu Lambebo Tonja, Wilhelmina NdapewaOnyothi Nekoto, Pelonomi Moiloa, Jade Abbott, Vukosi Marivate, and Benjamin Rosman. "The Esethu Framework: Reimagining Sustainable Dataset Governance and Curation for Low-Resource Languages." In Proceedings of the 63rd Annual Meeting of ACL (**ACL 2025**). Vienna, Austria.

Rita Ramos, Everlyn Asiko Chimoto, Maartje ter Hoeve and Natalie Schluter. "GRAMMAMT: Improving Machine Translation with Grammar-Informed In-Context Learning." In Proceedings of the 63rd Annual Meeting of ACL (**ACL 2025**). Vienna, Austria.

Amol, Cynthia Jayne, Everlyn Asiko Chimoto, Rose Delilah Gesicho, Antony M. Gitau, Naome A. Etori, Caringtone Kinyanjui, Steven Ndung'u, Lawrence Moruye, Samson Otieno Ooko, Kavengi Kitonga, Brian Muhia, Catherine Gitau, Antony Ndolo, Lilian D. A. Wanzare, Albert Njoroge Kahira and Ronald Tombe. "State of NLP in Kenya: A Survey." **Arxiv Preprint (2024)**.

Chimoto Everlyn Asiko, Jay Gala, Orevaoghene Ahia, Julia Kreutzer, Bruce A. Bassett and Sara Hooker. "Critical Learning Periods: Leveraging Early Training Dynamics for Efficient Data Pruning." **In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: ACL 2024.**

Jacobs, C., Rakotonirina, N.C., Chimoto, E.A., Bassett, B.A., Kamper, H. (2023) Towards hate speech detection in low-resource languages: Comparing ASR to acoustic word embeddings on Wolof and Swahili. **In INTERSPEECH 2023.**

Everlyn Chimoto and Bruce Bassett. 2022. Very Low Resource Sentence Alignment: Luhya and Swahili. **In Workshop on Technologies for Machine Translation of Low-Resource Languages (LoResMT 2022).** Gyeongju, Republic of Korea.

Everlyn Chimoto and Bruce Bassett. 2022. COMET-QE and Active Learning for Low-Resource Machine Translation. **In Findings of the Association for Computational Linguistics: EMNLP 2022.** Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates.

Idris Abdulmumin, Michael Beukman, Jesujoba Alabi, Chris Chinenye Emezue, Everlyn Chimoto, Tosin Adewumi, Shamsuddeen Muhammad, Mofetoluwa Adeyemi, Oreen Yousuf, Sahib Singh, and Tajuddeen Gwadabe. 2022. Separating Grains from the Chaff: Using Data Filtering to Improve Multilingual Translation for Low-Resourced African Languages. **In Seventh Conference on Machine Translation (WMT).** Abu Dhabi, United Arab Emirates (Hybrid).

Experience

Riara University, Kenya
May 2025 - Present **Faculty, School of Computing Sciences**
- *Co-authored a grant for teaching with AI, awarded by KENET*
- *Taught over 100 students Machine Learning, Neural Networks, Fuzzy Logic and Statistics for Data Science*

Lelapa AI, Kenya
January 2025 - October 2026 **Fundamental Research Scientist**
- *Co-authored 1 research paper, accepted at ACL 2025.*
- *Lead 1 research project, accepted at EACL 2026*

Apple, Denmark
March 2024 – Sept 2024 **Machine Learning and NLP Intern, Machine Learning Research(MLR)**
- *Collaborated on 1 research paper, accepted at ACL 2025*

Moringa School, Kenya
Sept 2019 – Dec 2023 **Data Science Technical Mentor**
- *Successfully running 3 data science classes. Providing support to over 80 students.*

Participation in Academic Events

AfricaNLP 2026
Rabat, Morocco
Organizer: Workshop site
Publication chair

AfricaNLP 2025
Vienna, Austria
Organizer: Workshop site
Managed mentorship program; Managed communication and sponsorship of attendees

Deep Learning Indaba 2023
Accra, Ghana
Organizer: Efficiency in African NLP @Deep Learning Indaba
Practical Author: LLMs for Everyone

NLP @ COMPASS
Cape Town, South Africa
Organizer: Workshop site
Wrote proposal; Built workshop site; Moderated the workshop

AfricaNLP 2023
Kigali, Rwanda
Organizer: Workshop site
Managed mentorship program; Managed reviewers for workshop paper submissions

EMNLP 2022
Abu Dhabi, UAE
Poster Presenter
Poster Title - COMET-QE and Active Learning for Low-Resource Machine Translation

Deep Learning Indaba 2022
Tunis, Tunisia
Attendee and Tutor
Session Tutored: Introduction to Transformers

Awards, Grants and Scholarships

2026: Thamsanqa Kambule Doctoral Award, Deep Learning India

2023: Full grant, Heidelberg Laureate Forum

2022: D&I grant, EMNLP

2021: AIMS Doctoral Training Fellowship, Quantum Leap Africa (QLA)

2021: Paul G. Allen Family Foundation Scholarship, African Institute for Mathematical Sciences(AIMS)

2019: Best Student Computer Science award by School of Computing and Informatics, Masinde Muliro University of Science and Technology

2019: Best Mentee in Data Science, KamiLimu

Leadership and Community Service

KenyaNLP Sep 2025 - Present	**KenyaNLP Lead and Organizer** Manage 5 working groups(data, evaluation, communication, writing, model research).
Masakhane Feb 2020 - Present	**Talk and Reading Group Organizer** Plan bi-weekly reading group meet-up to review speech technology research. Also, invite speakers to speak to members of the Masakhane community. 2 speakers presented their work in April and May.
WiMLDS, Nairobi Apr 2020 – Aug 2020	**Organizer** Planned deep-dives workshop series aimed at taking community members through a real-life Data Science project.